

ONE NODE → A CAMERA MOVE — GHOST TOWN

AtlasInput expands to the whole layered build; five buttons author the move; ● Bake delivers frames, MP4, USD.

FILE `atlas_input_cameramove_ghosttown_workflow.json` VERIFIED 2026-07-16

THE STORY

AtlasInput is the all-in-one entry node: at execution it EXPANDS into the real mini-graph — solve, depth, sky, four depth-band clean-plate layers with LaMa inpaint — so inner steps cache individually and missing packs degrade gracefully. One node carries what the staged master needs forty for.

The move authoring is deliberately simple: five one-click buttons (Orbit L/R, Pan L/R, Dolly In) on the detached Output Desk, fixed film grammar (24 fps, 100 frames), every move departing from the EXACT recovered camera. The 🔭 lens slider widens or tightens the playback framing without ever touching the solve. ● Bake steps the render camera through the path and fills the JPEG sequence, MP4, and time-sampled USD camera below.

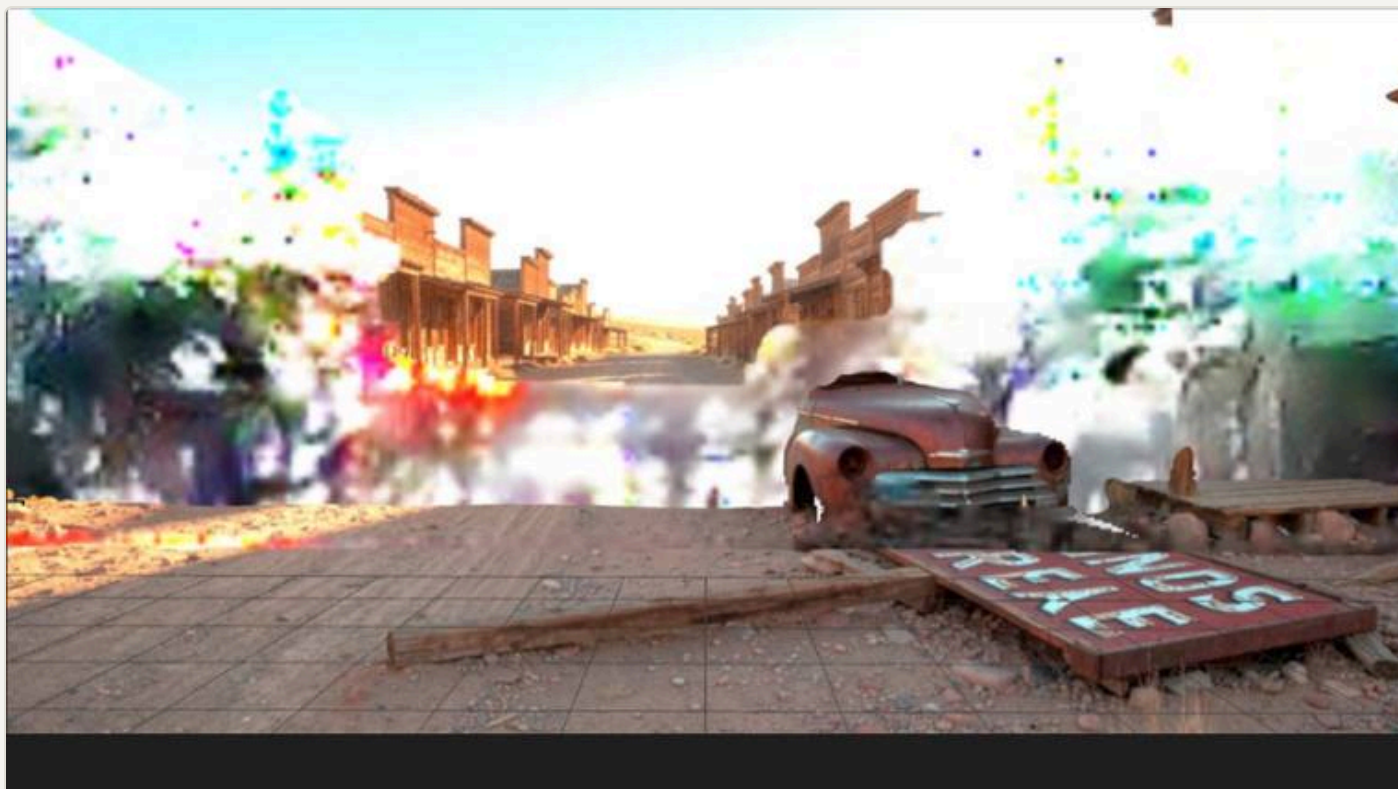
And the honest lesson this plate taught: know when to skip the bands. A continuously-receding street is not a stack of separable layers — the VLM's flat far card sliced the midground and inpaint smear leaked through seams. layers=0 (one full-depth mesh, mesh_resolution=1024) produced the clean take used in the guide's filmstrip. The bands remain right for genuinely layered scenes like the ocean castle.

IN THE VIEWPORT — PROJECTED VS. THE GREY MESH



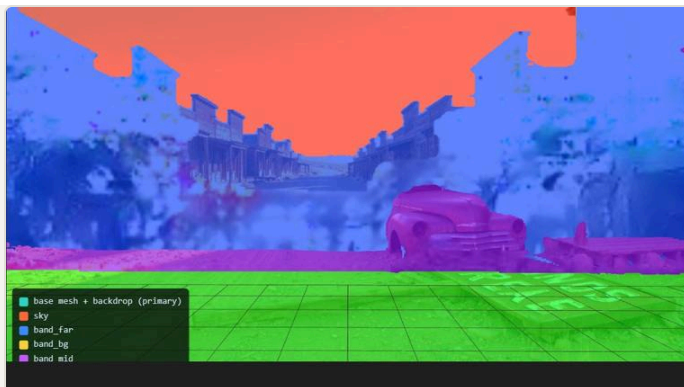
SOURCE PLATE

ghosttown_32bit_acescg.exr · ACEScg float — the single still photograph everything below is reconstructed from.



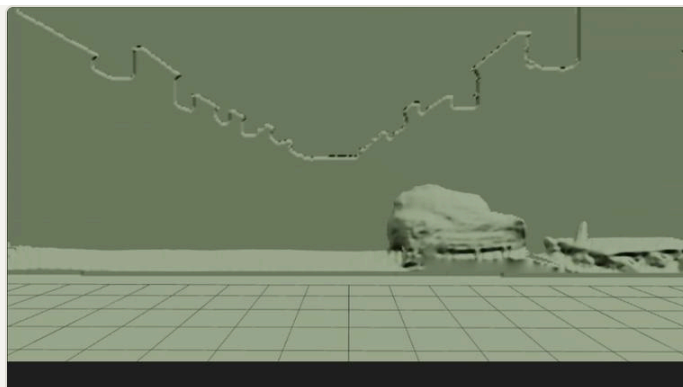
PROJECT ON

The photo reassembled on the recovered camera — texels assigned by ray, perfect from this view.



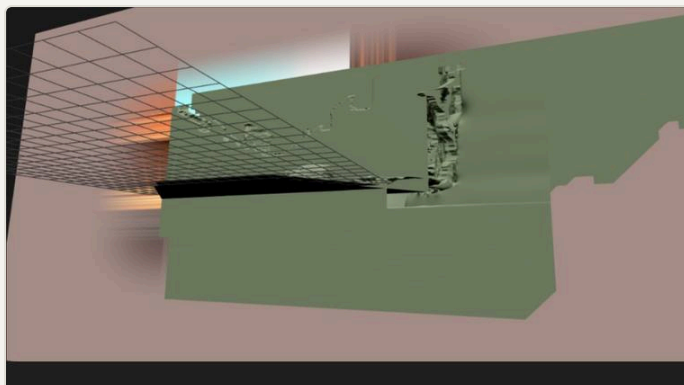
LAYER DEBUG

Each projection layer in its debug color, with the legend — the band decomposition at a glance.



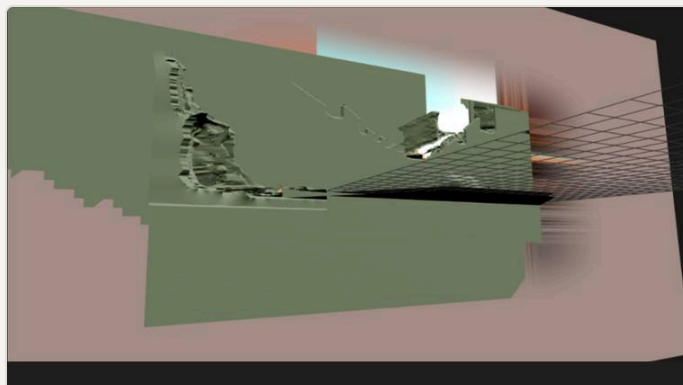
PROJECT OFF

The same geometry as a grey mesh, recovered view — what the depth-derived surfaces actually are.



GREY · ORBIT LEFT

Orbited off-axis: the reconstructed cone. Coverage ends where the camera never saw.



GREY · ORBIT RIGHT

The opposite angle — silhouette tears read as deliberate holes, not errors.

NODES ON STAGE

OCIORead

AtlasRegisterPlate

AtlasInput

AtlasAttachSourcePlate

AtlasViewportControls

AtlasBlockoutViewport

AtlasDebugReport

AtlasExportCameraPathUSD

VideoCombinePlus

SaveImageExtended

RETUNE ON YOUR PLATE

- **layers / sky are explicit.** layers=4, sky=True are SET, not inferred — use_vlm alone does not force them. For receding streets set layers=0 instead.
- **vlm_scope ships OFF.** ON lets VLM SAM prompts scope each band — powerful, but a partial segment match can gut a band. Turn on per-shot, not by default.
- **Dolly In is the clean marketing take.** On-axis, minimal disocclusion. Orbit shows more parallax but exposes inpaint smear on reveals — the honest comparison.

- ▶ **The USD export ships bypassed.** It errors pre-bake by design; un-bypass after ● Bake. The JPEG saver writes one black placeholder frame until then.

RUN-VERIFIED

RUN ✓ Full 5-layer master (sky + 4 bands, farthest-highest). Baked → Dolly In: 100 frames @ 24 fps — re-baked at 1920×1080 in single-mesh mode for the clean take. This workflow found and fixed two real bugs during verification (a zero-width VLM band and the vlm_scope trap).

REQUIREMENTS

OCIO/EXR env · VLM (lmstudio) · KJNodes · VideoCombinePlus · [usd] for the camera export